

cleartax

GLOBAL ENTERPRISE INFRASTRUCTURE

Beyond e-Invoicing

Scale, Security, and Enterprise-Grade Support

The Infrastructure That Earns CFO, Tax, and IT Sign-Off



1Bn+e-invoicing transactions
annually**5,000+**

Enterprise clients globally

50+

Countries covered

99.9%

Platform uptime SLA

e-Invoicing compliance is no longer a finance-only decision. By the time a mandate goes live, three functions need to have signed off – **the CFO who owns the control architecture, the tax head who will defend the numbers in an audit, and the CIO who must guarantee the platform stays online during a real-time clearance cycle.**

What follows is a direct answer to each of those three perspectives: what ClearTax has built, what the independent certifications actually mean, and why the infrastructure layer matters as much as the compliance layer when mandates arrive at scale.

"This is not an IT event. It is a change to the governance structure of your finance function."

Three perspectives. One infrastructure decision.

For the CFO

Your control architecture, your governance obligations, and the vendor risk questions that matter.

For the Tax Head

Reconciliation you can rely on, audit trails you can defend, and data that works for you.

For the IT / CIO

Uptime, latency, data residency, encryption, security posture, and partner ecosystem.

What this document covers:

Section 1 – For the CFO. Board-grade controls, the vendor risk question CFOs actually need to ask, and country-wise penalty exposure.

Section 2 – For the Tax Head. What tax-grade controls require of the platform, and the transactional intelligence playbook.

Section 3 – For the IT and CIO angle. Infrastructure specifications, security certifications, ERP integration, and on-the-ground support.

Section 4 – The architecture decision. Global compliance coverage by jurisdiction, and three things that should be architecturally true of any platform you select.

For the CFO

Your control architecture, your governance obligations, and the vendor risk questions that matter.

You Are Not Just Buying Compliance

The moment an invoice is submitted to a government clearance platform, the tax authority has real-time visibility into your cash flows, your supplier relationships, and your financial controls. **That is not an IT event. It is a change to the governance structure of your finance function.**

CFOs who treat this as an IT procurement will build the plumbing. CFOs who treat it as a control architecture decision will build something that actually holds up under audit, under board scrutiny, and under the operational pressure of a mandate going live simultaneously in six countries.

What board-grade controls look like in an e-invoicing platform:

CONTROL DIMENSION	WHAT IT MEANS IN PRACTICE
Data isolation	Your compliance data, GL records, and audit history never share infrastructure with another organisation. Tenant isolation is architectural, not policy-based.
Human approval checkpoints	No submission reaches a tax authority without a human approval step. The platform drafts and validates; your team authorises. The AI assists – it does not act unilaterally.
Immutable audit trails	Every transaction carries a tamper-evident log from creation through government acknowledgement. The record cannot be altered retroactively.
Books-to-authority reconciliation	Your general ledger and the government's copy of every invoice are continuously reconciled. Discrepancies surface before an auditor finds them.
Role-based access	Approval, submission, and audit-view functions are separated. Who can see, who can act, and who can approve are distinct and logged.

"When the mandate changes at 48 hours' notice — and it will — who updates your platform?"

The Vendor Risk Question CFOs Actually Need to Ask

Most vendor evaluations focus on format coverage and ERP integration. Those matter. But the question that distinguishes a good implementation from a dangerous one is simpler: **when the mandate changes at 48 hours' notice – and it will – who updates your platform? How fast does it happen, and what is their contractual obligation if they are late?**

Three vendor risk scenarios that CFOs routinely underestimate:

A vendor **without government accreditation** means you are using an unrecognised platform. In the UAE, using a non-accredited PEPPOL Access Point creates penalties that fall on you, not the vendor.

A vendor **whose certifications lapsed** creates compliance exposure that is invisible until an auditor asks for documentation. ISO 27001 and SOC 2 Type II require annual renewal and an independent re-audit.

A vendor **whose support is offshore and pooled** means that when a real-time clearance rejection cascades into a payment hold at midnight, no one with authority to fix it is reachable.

Why Consolidation Is the CFO's Strongest Risk Move

Managing e-invoicing compliance through five fragmented country-specific vendors does not reduce risk. It multiplies it. Each vendor relationship is a separate SLA, a separate audit trail, a separate escalation path, and a separate failure point.

A consolidated global compliance platform – one contract, one dashboard, one SLA to hold – gives the CFO a single point of accountability. When France, Poland, the UAE, and Malaysia are all live simultaneously, that accountability structure is not a nice-to-have. **It is the only model that survives board scrutiny.**

WHY THIS MATTERS

One contract. One dashboard. One SLA to hold. That is the accountability structure that survives board scrutiny when multiple mandates go live at once.

Fragmented vs. consolidated, one vendor relationship at a time:

Five fragmented vendors

A separate SLA, a separate audit trail, a separate escalation path, and a separate failure point – for every country.

One consolidated platform

One contract, one dashboard, one SLA – across France, Poland, the UAE, and Malaysia simultaneously.

Country-wise Penalty & Financial Exposure

Non-compliance with e-invoicing mandates can result in financial penalties, VAT recovery challenges, and operational disruption. The table below highlights the potential exposure across key jurisdictions to help prioritise implementation efforts.

COUNTRY	PER-INVOICE FINE / PENALTY	VAT CREDIT DENIAL RISK	BUSINESS CLOSURE / BLOCKING THRESHOLD
UAE	AED 100 per non-compliant invoice, capped at AED 5,000/month. Failure to implement e-invoicing: AED 5,000/month.	High – VAT substantiation risk where invoices are not exchanged through the mandated framework.	High – inability to operate through an accredited service provider can prevent compliant invoice exchange.
France	€50 per non-compliant invoice, capped at €15,000 per year.	High – input VAT recovery may be challenged for non-compliant invoicing.	High – invoices must flow through accredited PDP infrastructure once mandated.
Germany	Up to €5,000 per offence for failure to issue compliant e-invoices.	High – loss or delay of input VAT deduction is explicitly identified as a consequence of non-compliance.	Medium – invoice rejection by customers and public authorities rather than direct business shutdown.
Saudi Arabia	SAR 5,000–50,000 per violation for non-issuance, non-archiving, invoice modification, and related offences.	High – VAT audit exposure and invoice validity issues.	Very high – clearance failure means invoices are not legally validated through the ZATCA ecosystem.
Poland	Up to 100% of the VAT amount shown on the invoice; where VAT is not shown, up to 18.7% of invoice value.	Very high – directly linked to VAT settlement and deduction rights.	Very high – mandatory KSeF submission required for compliant invoice issuance.
Spain	Administrative fines apply under tax compliance rules, but no widely published per-invoice e-invoicing penalty yet for the upcoming mandate.	Medium–High	Medium
UK	No mandatory B2B e-invoicing regime currently. Standard VAT invoice penalties apply.	Low–Medium	Low

Country-wise Penalty & Financial Exposure (continued)

COUNTRY	PER-INVOICE FINE / PENALTY	VAT CREDIT DENIAL RISK	BUSINESS CLOSURE / BLOCKING THRESHOLD
Netherlands	No broad mandatory domestic B2B e-invoicing penalties currently.	Low–Medium	Low
Ireland	No confirmed domestic B2B e-invoicing penalty framework currently.	Low–Medium	Low
Singapore	No mandatory nationwide e-invoicing penalty regime.	Low	Low
Australia	No mandatory nationwide B2B e-invoicing penalty regime.	Low	Low
Philippines	Tax Code penalties apply for non-compliance with e-invoicing/reporting obligations; enforcement is generally tax-administration based rather than fixed per invoice.	Medium	Low–Medium
Oman	OMR 1,000–10,000 for failure to issue a compliant e-invoice, wrong format, missing UUID, QR code, or digital signature.	Pending regulatory confirmation	Pending regulatory confirmation
Qatar	Uncleared B2B/B2G invoices are not legally valid.	Pending regulatory confirmation	Pending regulatory confirmation

DISCLAIMER

Penalty frameworks, enforcement practices, and VAT treatment continue to evolve across many jurisdictions. The information presented above is intended for general informational purposes only and does not constitute legal or tax advice. Organisations should consult local regulations and qualified advisors to validate the latest requirements, penalty provisions, and enforcement timelines applicable to their specific circumstances.

For the Tax Head

Reconciliation you can rely on, audit trails you can defend, and data that works for you.

Your Filing Calendar Is Gone

In the legacy model, tax compliance happened in cycles. Invoice in January, VAT return in February, audit query later. You had time to reconstruct, reconcile, and respond.

In a clearance model, that window is gone. The government has your invoice data the moment it is issued. India is sending compliance notices algorithmically, **20 times more frequently than three years ago**. Saudi Arabia's ZATCA escalates fines automatically. The reconciliation that used to happen quarterly now needs to be continuous.

"The reconciliation that used to happen quarterly now needs to be continuous."

What changed, in three moves:

From cyclical to real-time. The government has your invoice data the moment it is issued – not at quarter-end.

From manual to algorithmic enforcement. India is sending compliance notices algorithmically, 20 times more frequently than three years ago.

From reactive to continuous. Saudi Arabia's ZATCA escalates fines automatically – reconciliation can no longer wait for an audit query.

20x

more frequent algorithmic compliance notices in India than three years ago

0

filing cycles left – reconciliation now has to be continuous, not quarterly

What Tax-Grade Controls Require of the Platform

Five capabilities the platform has to guarantee – and the audit scenario each one is built to survive.

CAPABILITY	WHAT IT PROTECTS	AUDIT SCENARIO
End-to-end transaction logs	Every invoice from ERP to government acknowledgement is logged with timestamps and status codes.	The auditor asks for proof that invoice #14,382 was submitted, validated, and acknowledged on a specific date.
Books-to-authority reconciliation	Your declared output VAT matches the government's copy of every invoice. Mismatches surface in the platform, not in a notice.	ZATCA cross-references your submission against buyer declarations and finds a gap.
GL match and transactional intelligence	Invoice data is matched against GL entries automatically. Unmatched items are flagged before filing.	The tax authority runs automated matching. You already have the reconciliation ready.
Input VAT credit recovery	Structured invoice data enables automated identification of missed or under-claimed input VAT credits.	Brazil recovered through this mechanism. Your platform should be doing the same.
Role-based access and approval	Reviewer, approver, and submitter roles are separated. Every approval is logged with a timestamp and user identity.	The internal audit asks who authorised a bulk submission and when.

RECOVERABLE REVENUE, NOT HISTORICAL TRIVIA

Structured invoice data enables automated identification of missed or under-claimed input VAT credits – the same mechanism Brazil used to recover revenue at scale.

The Transactional Intelligence Playbook

Once e-invoicing infrastructure is live and government-validated invoice data is flowing in real time, that data becomes a financial asset – not just a compliance record.

DATA ASSET	HOW IT CREATES VALUE
Pre-filled VAT returns	Government-validated invoice data populates your VAT return automatically. Italy's SDI model and India's trajectory both point here. Filing becomes verification, not reconstruction.
Working capital optimisation	Validated invoice data supports dynamic discounting and supply chain financing. In Mexico, SMEs used e-invoice data to access early payment programmes.
Predictive audit defence	Transaction patterns are analysed before submission. Likely rejection triggers and cross-match anomalies are flagged and resolved before they reach the authority.
Missed credit recovery	Structured data enables automated scanning for input VAT credits that were missed or incorrectly claimed. This is recoverable revenue, not historical trivia.

"Filing becomes verification, not reconstruction."

Where this plays out today:

Italy – SDI model

Government-validated invoice data populates VAT returns automatically. India's trajectory points the same way.

Mexico – SME financing

SMEs used e-invoice data to access early payment and supply chain financing programmes.

Brazil – credit recovery

Structured invoice data enabled automated identification and recovery of missed or under-claimed input VAT credits.

Predictive audit defence

Transaction patterns analysed before submission – rejection triggers and cross-match anomalies flagged before they reach the authority.

For the IT and CIO Angle

Uptime, latency, data residency, encryption, security posture, and partner ecosystem.

The Platform Has to Work

In a clearance model, the platform is in the critical path of every invoice. If the platform is down, invoices are not being issued. Suppliers are not being paid. Customers are not receiving goods.

Infrastructure specifications:

DIMENSION	CLEARTAX SPECIFICATION
Uptime SLA	99.9% platform uptime SLA – contractually committed, not aspirational.
Cloud infrastructure	Hosted across AWS, OCI or GCP with local region deployment per jurisdiction. Infrastructure does not cross borders under normal operations.
Data residency	Each region runs on dedicated, sovereign infrastructure. Your UAE data stays in the UAE. Your India data stays in India. No cross-border transfer under normal operations.
Encryption	Data encrypted at rest and in transit. All API connections use token-based authentication. SFTP transfers are encrypted.
Latency	Real-time validation and government submission designed for clearance-model speed. Invoice approval-to-acknowledgement within seconds, not minutes.
Disaster recovery	ISO 22301:2019 certified business continuity. Tested recovery plans with defined RTO and RPO for critical services.
Penetration testing	Independent third-party VAPT conducted – not self-assessed. Results documented and available under NDA.

"The compliance platform is now operational infrastructure — not a periodic filing tool."

99.9%

contractually committed uptime SLA

3

cloud providers – AWS, OCI, or GCP – with local region deployment

0

cross-border data transfers under normal operations

Security Certifications: What Each One Actually Means

Every certification listed here was issued by an independent auditing or accreditation body. Each requires evidence – not documentation.

ISO 27001:2022

Information security management – 2022 edition, independently audited.

SOC 2 Type II

Controls tested in operation over time – not just designed.

ISO 22301:2019

Business continuity – tested recovery plans for disruptions.

SAMA

Saudi Arabian Monetary Authority cybersecurity framework – KSA operations.

RMIT

Bank Negara Malaysia risk management framework – Malaysia operations.

GDPR

EU data protection law – privacy by design, SCCs available.

FTA Compliant

UAE Federal Tax Authority – VAT data handling standards.

IRP Designation

Indian government Invoice Registration Portal – government infrastructure trust.

VAPT Certified

Independent penetration testing – not self-assessed.

WHAT ISO 27001 AND SOC 2 TYPE II ACTUALLY PROVE

ISO 27001 requires independent auditors to verify that controls across people, processes, and technology are working – not just documented. SOC 2 Type II tests whether security, availability, and confidentiality controls actually operate consistently over a sustained period of time. These are the same standards your bank and your Big 4 auditor hold themselves to. Ask any vendor for their current certificate, not just a claim.

9

independent certifications and government designations held

2022

edition of ISO 27001 currently held – independently audited

0

self-assessed claims – every certification requires third-party evidence

ERP Integration and Partner Ecosystem

Security does not stop at the platform boundary. Every connection to your ERP, procurement system, or government portal carries the same security standards as the core platform.

CAPABILITY	TECHNICAL SPECIFICATION
SAP integration	SAP-certified native connector. Covers S/4HANA and legacy ECC. Pre-built, not custom-built for each implementation.
Oracle integration	Oracle-validated connector for Oracle Fusion Cloud and E-Business Suite. API-first, not file-based.
Microsoft Dynamics 365	Native connector for Dynamics 365 Finance. Covers both cloud and on-premises deployments.
Non-ERP sources	POS systems, subscription billing, SaaS invoicing, and custom systems connected via REST API. No transaction is invisible.
Partner ecosystem	Big 4 and major accounting firms across every market. Partners go through documented due diligence before joining the network.
API authentication	Token-based authentication on all API connections. All calls logged with timestamp, user identity, and status.

Pre-built, not custom-built, across the ERP stack:

SAP

S/4HANA and legacy ECC – SAP-certified native connector.

Oracle

Fusion Cloud and E-Business Suite – Oracle-validated, API-first.

Microsoft Dynamics 365

Finance module – cloud and on-premises deployments covered.

NO TRANSACTION IS INVISIBLE

POS systems, subscription billing, SaaS invoicing, and custom systems connect via REST API alongside the core ERP connectors – and the same Big 4 partner ecosystem, vetted through documented due diligence, sits across every market.

On-the-Ground Support

A clearance-model rejection at midnight in a high-transaction-volume business is not a ticket to raise. It is an immediate operational event. **The support model has to match the operational model.**

100+

in-house tax experts, not engineers trained on the platform

7

global office locations with physical, in-region presence

48h

SLA to deploy schema and format updates after a mandate change

SUPPORT DIMENSION	WHAT CLEARTAX PROVIDES
In-region teams	Local teams in key jurisdictions – not offshore-only coverage. When Saudi Arabia's ZATCA releases a schema update, the people who understand it are in the region.
Regulatory update SLA	Schema changes and format updates are deployed at, or within 48 hours of, a government mandate change. The vendor absorbs the update cycle – not your IT team.
100+ in-house tax experts	Not engineers trained on the platform. Tax specialists who understand regulatory interpretation, local enforcement patterns, and can advise on positioning – not just implementation.
Escalation path to engineering	Production issues escalate directly to engineering with defined resolution SLAs. Pooled support does not sit between your business and the fix.
7 global office locations	Physical presence in the markets you operate in. Regulatory relationships are built through local presence, not remote monitoring.

"The support model has to match the operational model."

Global Compliance Coverage by Jurisdiction

Where ClearTax is certified, accredited, or designated by government bodies.

COUNTRY / REGION	ACTIVE CERTIFICATIONS AND DESIGNATIONS
India	ISO 27001:2022 · SOC 2 Type II · IRP Designation (GSTN/NIC) · GSP / ASP / IRP · DPDP Act 2023 aligned
UAE	ISO 27001:2022 · ISO 22301:2019 · FTA Compliant · UAE PDPL aligned · Peppol Access Point certified
Saudi Arabia	ISO 27001:2022 · SOC 2 Type II · SAMA Compliant · KSA PDPL aligned · Local data hosting · ZATCA accredited
Malaysia	ISO 27001:2022 · SOC 2 Type II · RMIT Compliant · Local data hosting
Poland / Germany	ISO 27001:2022 · KSeF integration · XRechnung / Peppol BIS formats supported
Global (50+ countries)	Unified compliance layer across all jurisdictions. New mandate activation is configuration, not a new IT project.
France	ISO 27001:2022 · SOC 2 Type II · GDPR aligned · DGFIP PA registration · Peppol Access Point certified
Belgium	ISO 27001:2022 · SOC 2 Type II · GDPR aligned · Peppol mandate compliant · FPS Finance listed · Standard Contractual Clauses available

CONFIGURATION, NOT A NEW IT PROJECT

Across 50+ countries, ClearTax runs a unified compliance layer. New mandate activation is configuration, not a new IT project – the same architecture that is government-designated infrastructure in India and ZATCA-accredited in Saudi Arabia extends to every market it enters.

50+

countries under one unified compliance layer

8

jurisdictions with active government certifications and designations shown here

2

government designations held directly – IRP in India, ZATCA accreditation in Saudi Arabia

The Architecture Decision

Three things that should be architecturally true of any platform you select:

1 Your data is yours alone.

The system should be architecturally designed so your compliance data, GL records, and notice history never mix with another company's data. Tenant isolation must be structural – not a configuration toggle or a contractual promise that is hard to verify.

2 It meets the standards your auditors already recognise.

SOC 2 Type II certified and ISO 27001 compliant – the same bar your bank and your Big 4 auditor hold themselves to. Ask for the current certificate, the scope of the audit, and the date of the last independent test.

3 Nothing reaches the tax authority without a human approving it.

Before any submission reaches a government platform, your team reviews and approves it. The AI drafts, validates, and flags – your people authorise. In several jurisdictions, this is a governance requirement, not just an operational preference.

The CFOs who will look back on 2026–2030 with confidence are not the ones who raced to compliance. They are the ones who built compliance infrastructure that became a control layer, an audit defence capability, and a data asset – a platform that earns sign-off from all three functions, not just the one holding the budget.

A CFO who signs off on governance. A Tax Head who can defend every transaction. A CIO who knows the platform will not go down when a mandate goes live.

Over a billion transactions annually. 5,000+ enterprises across 50+ countries. Government-designated infrastructure in India. ZATCA-accredited in Saudi Arabia. SOC 2 Type II and ISO 27001 independently audited. In-region teams in every market we operate.

Request a briefing for your CFO, Tax, or IT leadership team →